What the Keeper Planted

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 5, Episode 9

Nib read the work log and prepared to clear the screen again. Lark showed him the check beside the completed job. Yesterday's work and tomorrow's questions were on different pages. Repeating everything would hide the useful fact that the inlet repair was already done.

“We could plant it all again,” Nib offered eagerly. “We can read what was already done,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **bank**

“Ed can sound /t/, /d/, or /id/ in these examples,” Lark modeled clearly. “Listen to jumped, played, and planted. The same ending spelling marks completed actions, but its spoken sound changes. We'll read each whole word and connect it to what happened.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jumped, played, planted. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the completed-task entry,” Lark invited gently. “Which work should stay checked while we inspect the remaining linkage?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam planted. Pat played by the bank.**

“Who completed the planting?” Lark asked gently. “Which action belongs to Pat instead?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib left the repaired screen alone. Lark added the improved-flow observation to its finished entry, then opened the current linkage note. Outside, the water wheel turned while the chime arm waited in its catch. That difference was the new question, not a reason to undo the old repair.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write planted beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept completed work and remaining questions on separate lines. The wheel's motion could now be compared directly with the waiting arm, with no new leaves introduced to explain away the mismatch.